

Steve Sedlmayr

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16 SEPTEMBER 2026

Attn: Assembly Committee on Privacy and Consumer Protection
1020 N Street, Room 162,
Sacramento, CA 95814
(916) 319-2200

**Attn: Select Committee on Growing Impact of Artificial
Intelligence in California**
State Capitol, Room 3076,
Sacramento, CA 95814
(916) 651-4034

Dear Chair Bauer-Kahan and Members of the Committees,

Droidknot LLC is a two-member, independent game development studio with more than 30 years of combined experience in the San Francisco Bay Area technology sector, including at companies like EA, Netflix, the Office of the CTO at Microsoft and Y-Combinator Research. We would like to present for your consideration, and propose our AI labeling standard ARTS—The AI Rating Transparency System—as a holistic, turn-key disclosure solution for companies making products containing AI technology.

The explosion of AI-based products over the past 5 years has overwhelmed consumers, citizens and legislators alike with a dizzying array of goods and services that they do not know how to evaluate. While current legislative efforts frequently rely on speculative, unscientific, sci-fi metrics emanating from the AI industry's marketing efforts, such as "superintelligence," the ARTS standard provides a process-comprehensive empirical framework that scores the entire lifecycle of an AI product—from model training and natural resource footprint through code production and deployment.

Crucially, our standard provides eight (8) direct regulatory compliance points out-of-the-box, seamlessly harmonizing with active domestic and international laws, including the EU AI Act (Article 50), California SB 942, the New York Synthetic Performer Law, and South Korea's AI Basic Act (KAIBA). It accomplishes this through a human-centric, cascading information system that scales effortlessly from individual creators and small indie studios up to enterprise cloud applications and even robotics, AI devices and autonomous vehicles. It can be applied to *any product that contains AI features*.

To assist your committee and legislative analysts in evaluating this framework, the enclosed packet has been organized into three sections:

1. This letter.
2. The core policy brief: An evaluation of the macroeconomic necessity of objective labeling over blunt, monopolistic software bans.
3. The ARTS Explainer: A detailed technical whitepaper mapping our 4 Levels of Detail (LODs), 4 symbolic system safety modifiers, environmental metrics, and ARTS applied to real-world examples, including a color-coded matrix displaying exact, human-verified assessments across 22 distinct, real-world AI technology products.

I look forward to discussing how this turn-key standard can be utilized to protect consumer awareness and safeguard independent software innovation within your jurisdiction without creating a regulatory moat for monopolistic AI corporations. Please contact me at your earliest convenience to arrange a brief technical consultation with your policy staff.

Submitted Respectfully,

Steve Sedlmayr,
Co-founder & Principal Software Engineer, Droidknot LLC

Open-Source & Technical Access

The AI Rating Transparency System (ARTS) is a public-domain framework released under a **Creative Commons Zero (CC0) Universal License**. To maintain complete transparency, the live repository—including raw SVG vector templates for consumer labels, examples, and the official standard—is publicly hosted on GitHub.

- **Official Standard Repository:**
github.com/ryamldess/Droidknot-ARTS/
- **Digital Standards Gateway:** droidknot.com/ARTS

Technical committees and staffers are encouraged to inspect the repository directly to evaluate how the standard is applied.